

Rujie Cheng

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania

Philadelphia, PA

Master of City Planning & Certificate in GIS and Spatial Analysis

Aug 2024 – May 2026

- GPA: 3.91/4.0; Weitzman School of Design Scholarship; Bruce J. Hansen Award
- Relevant Coursework: Modeling Geographic Objects/Space, Statistical and Data Mining Methods for Urban Data Analysis, Multimodal Transport, Urban Economics and Public Finance, Public Policy Analytics

Peking University

Beijing, China

Bachelor's Degree in Sociology

Sept 2019 – Jul 2024

- GPA: 3.81/4.0; Outstanding Graduate; Outstanding Public Service Scholarship

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Toole Design Group

Pittsburgh, PA

Planning Intern

Jun 2026 – Present

- Used QGIS to build and manage spatial datasets, perform spatial analysis, and visualize geospatial data; produced 20+ deliverable-ready maps across multiple active transportation projects and proposal pursuits
- Developed a 36-page transportation and mobility existing conditions report for the Allegheny County comprehensive plan update, translating complex datasets into clear maps and findings for client review
- Supported a PennDOT Vulnerable Road User Safety Education Program pilot in Pittsburgh by engaging directly with community members, gathering feedback, and informing materials for broader public release

Philadelphia Industrial Development Corporation (PIDC)

Philadelphia, PA

Navy Yard GIS & Planning Intern

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Developed an employer-provided transit incentive study, authoring memos with existing policies, best practices, and 3 employer engagement strategy recommendations for Navy Yard's multimodal campaign
- Researched and prepared 4 briefs of grant opportunities, outlining potential funding sources for projects in energy infrastructure, mobility, and workforce development
- Maintained and updated the Navy Yard's campus asset and shuttle operations databases in Microsoft Excel and Salesforce, advancing data precision by 15% and enabling streamlined data-driven decision-making processes

SELECTED PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Redevelopment Plan for the Park City Center in Lancaster, PA (Group Project)

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

- Co-developed a three-scenario redevelopment report to inform the City of Lancaster's Small Area Plan development for Park City Center, integrating site circulation, parking, land-use allocation, and related implementation considerations
- Conducted housing market analysis for Lancaster and the project-area census tract; compiled property-level rent data to support discounted cash flow inputs and scenario evaluation
- Led final report production; created templates in InDesign and Illustrator and managed final QA/QC for print-ready export

Bike Share Usage Projection for Philadelphia Using Space-Time Modeling (Individual Project)

Apr 2025 – May 2025

- Built a space-time predictive model in R integrating IndeGo trip data, Census socio-economic data, and ASOS weather data to forecast hourly bike demand at the station level, achieving prediction errors within one trip per station-hour
- Identified key spatial-demand patterns; devised truck-based rebalancing intervention for high-demand and underserved areas

Haddon Township Downtown Action Plan (Group Project)

Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Collaborated in a team of 7 to develop a downtown revitalization action plan for Haddon Avenue in Haddon Township, NJ, translating field findings into prioritized actionable strategies for placemaking, business support, housing, and mobility
- Conducted block-by-block field audits of curb ramps, street furniture, and pedestrian crossings; built a geocoded GIS inventory and mapped pedestrian infrastructure gaps to support safety and accessibility project prioritization

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

Urban Planning: AICP Candidate (exam passed November 2025)

GIS & Data Analysis: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, R, SQL, Python, STATA, SPSS, Salesforce, Microsoft Excel

Design & Visualization: Adobe Creative Suite (InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop), Power BI

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate)